

WHEN WILL MIRACLES HAPPEN IN THE CHURCH?

TEXT: **Luke 5:1-10** “And it came to pass, that, as the people pressed upon him to hear the word of God, he stood by the lake of Gennesaret, ²And saw two ships standing by the lake: but the fishermen were gone out of them, and were washing *their* nets. ³And he entered into one of the ships, which was Simon's, and prayed him that he would thrust out a little from the land. And he sat down, and taught the people out of the ship. ⁴Now when he had left speaking, he said unto Simon, **Launch out into the deep, and let down your nets for a draught.** ⁵And Simon answering said unto him, Master, we have toiled all the night, and have taken nothing: nevertheless at thy word I will let down the net. ⁶And when they had this done, they inclosed a great multitude of fishes: and their net brake. ⁷And they beckoned unto *their* partners, which were in the other ship, that they should come and help them. And they came, and filled both the ships, so that they began to sink. ⁸When Simon Peter saw *it*, he fell down at Jesus' knees, saying, Depart from me; for I am a sinful man, O Lord. ⁹For he was astonished, and all that were with him, at the draught of the fishes which they had taken: ¹⁰And so *was* also James, and John, the sons of Zebedee, which were partners with Simon. And Jesus said unto Simon, **Fear not; from henceforth thou shalt catch men.**”

John 14:12-14 “Verily, verily, I say unto you, He that believeth on me, the works that I do shall he do also; and greater works than these shall he do; because I go unto my Father. ¹³And whatsoever ye shall ask in my name, that will I do, that the Father may be glorified in the Son. ¹⁴If ye shall ask any thing in my name, I will do *it*.”

INTRO: Jesus is about to leave Earth for Heaven via the cross, and he tells his disciples here in the Fourteenth chapter of the book of John that he is going to prepare a place for them, and that eventually they will be reunited in his Fathers house of many mansions!

Jesus tells them that he is the way the truth and the life, and that no man can come to the Father except by him!

In verse Twelve Jesus say's "**Verily, verily, I say unto you, He that believeth on me, the works that I do shall he do also;**"

My goodness that's good news if I ever heard it, the disciples are now going to be able to do the works that Jesus has been doing the past Three and One Half years!

Look at the works that Jesus has done that now the disciples are going to be able to do;

John 2 He turned the water into wine!

John 4 Jesus heals the nobleman's son without ever going to his house!

Luke 5 the disciples fish all night and catch nothing. Jesus advises them to fish on the other side of the boat, and they caught so many fish that they had to borrow other boats to haul the fish! There were so many fish that the boats almost lost their buoyancy and their nets began to break!

He cast out devils on numerous occasions!

He cleansed the lepers!

He unstopped deaf ears!

He opened blinded eyes!

He caused the dumb to speak!

He healed those who were paralyzed!

He raised the dead!

He miraculously fed multitudes of hungry people with a little boys lunch!

He stilled the storm on the sea with three simple words, PEACE BE STILL!

He walked on water!

He knew where fish were at who had enough money in their mouth to satisfy the IRS!

He could cast a spell on a tree that would cause it to die from it's roots up!

How many would like to be able to do what Jesus did! He said you could! **"Verily, verily, I say unto you, He that believeth on me, the works that I do shall he do also;"**

Not only that, notice what else he say's: **"and greater works than these shall he do; because I go unto my Father."**

Now, I have always believed this to mean that Jesus was going to the Father, and that the Father was going to send the Holy Spirit to indwell believers and that we were going to do **GREATER** works than Jesus because of the quantity of the Miracles!

How could you do a **GREATER** work than raise a person from the dead?

I'm sure that to some degree this is what Jesus is talking about!

However after a little research I am convinced that he was primarily addressing a totally different issue! The word **GREATER** here comes from the Greek word **MEIZON** (mide-zone), and literally means **GREATER**!

How can you do a **GREATER** work than Jesus done?

ILLUSTRATION: Raising a person from the dead- Healing a person previously unable to walk, etc....

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